- Retrieve a list of documents from an index, given the document IDs.
- Retrieve a list of documents from multiple indexes, given the document IDs.

Elasticsearch exposes a multi-document API (`_mget`) to satisfy these requirements. For example, to fetch a list of documents given IDs, we can use `_mget` API as shown in the following listing.

Listing 5.9 Fetching multiple documents at once

```
GET movies/_mget
{
  "ids" : ["1", "12", "19", "34"]
}
```

Figure 5.8 shows the format of the call to fetch multiple documents from various indexes. As you can see, the `_mget` endpoint is provided with a JSON-formatted request object. The `docs` key inside the request expects an array of document `_index` and `_id` pairs that we can use to fetch documents from multiple indexes. The code in the next listing fetches documents from three different indexes.

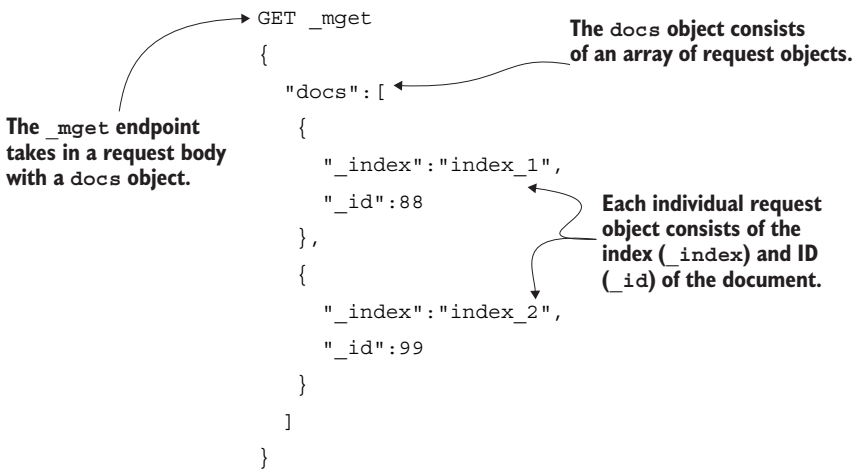


Figure 5.8 Fetching multiple documents using the `_mget` API

Listing 5.10 Fetching documents from three different indexes

```
GET _mget
{
  "docs":[
    {
      "_index":"classic_movies",
      "_id":11
    },
```

_mget call with no index mentioned in the URL

The first index is provided here.